Which chronic conditions will fill the caseload?

Five conditions tracked by the national surveillance system. Pick a province; every number below is for that province and the sex chosen.

Province or territory: British Columbia

Sex: Both sexes

+164K
More people with diabetes than 10 years earlier

9.3
Diabetes, age-standardized prevalence (%)

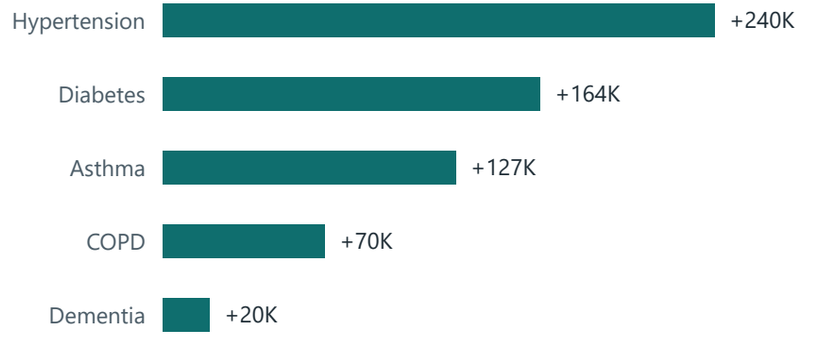
-0.1
Diabetes, points above or below Canada

36K
New diabetes cases in the latest year

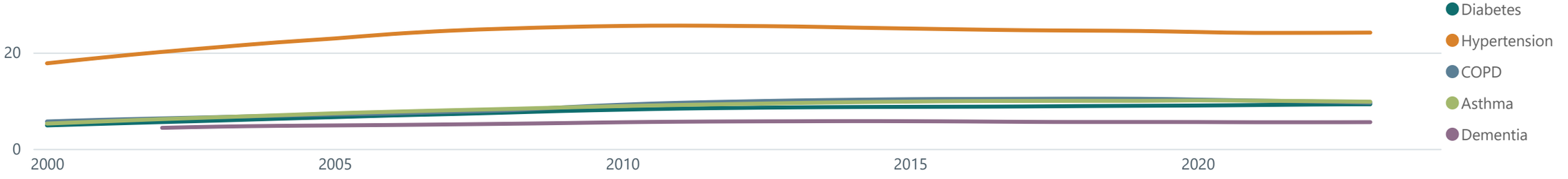
Who the province is caring for, latest year

Condition	People living with it	Added in 10 years	Prevalence %	vs Canada (pts)	New-case rate, 10-yr change
Hypertension	1,174,755	+239,735	24.2	-0.4	+13%
Diabetes	562,280	+163,940	9.3	-0.1	+7%
Asthma	573,705	+127,300	9.8	-1.9	-18%
COPD	346,025	+70,405	9.6	+0.1	-46%
Dementia	71,885	+20,275	5.6	-0.2	+3%

Growth in people living with each condition, 10 years



Age-standardized prevalence (%), 2000 to latest



Source: Public Health Agency of Canada, Canadian Chronic Disease Surveillance System (CCDSS), Public Health Infobase, read 8 October 2026. Rates are age-standardized; fiscal years (2023 = 2023-24). Open Government Licence - Canada.

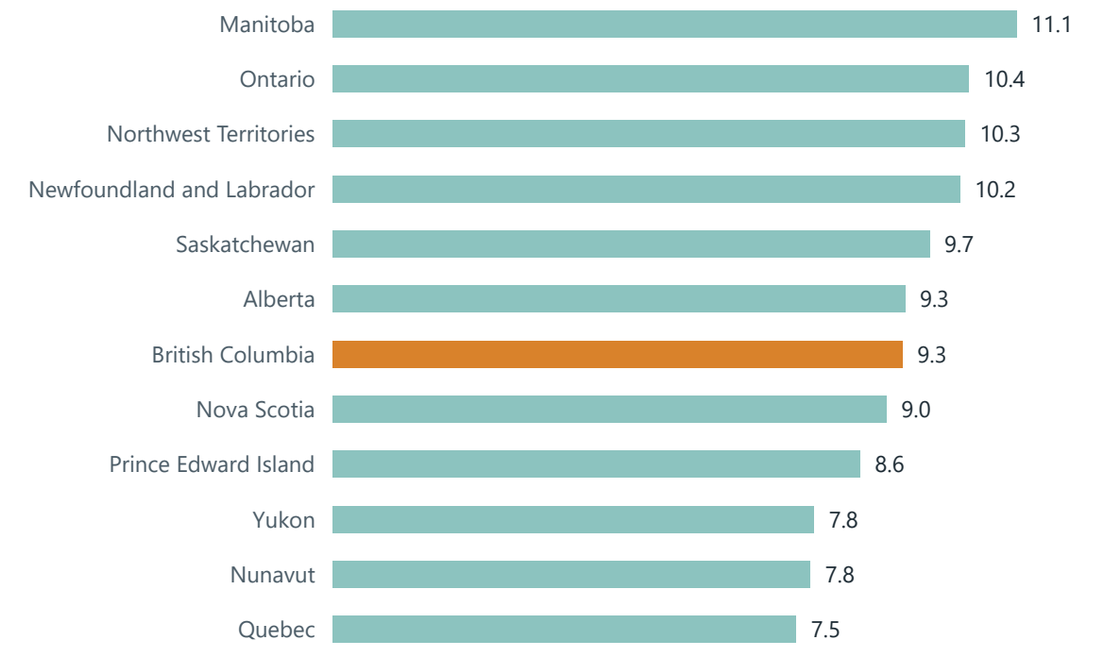
Is the province above or below the rest of Canada?

Age-standardized rates remove differences in age structure, so provinces can be compared fairly. British Columbia is highlighted.

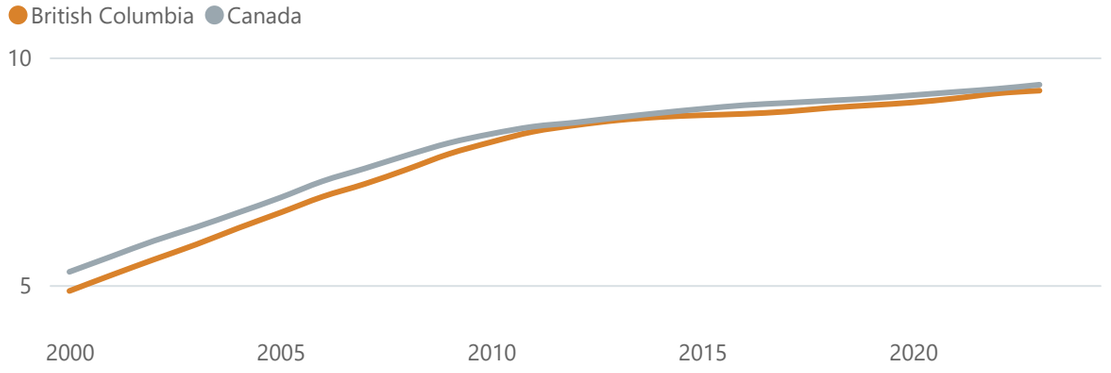
Condition: Diabetes

Sex: Both sexes

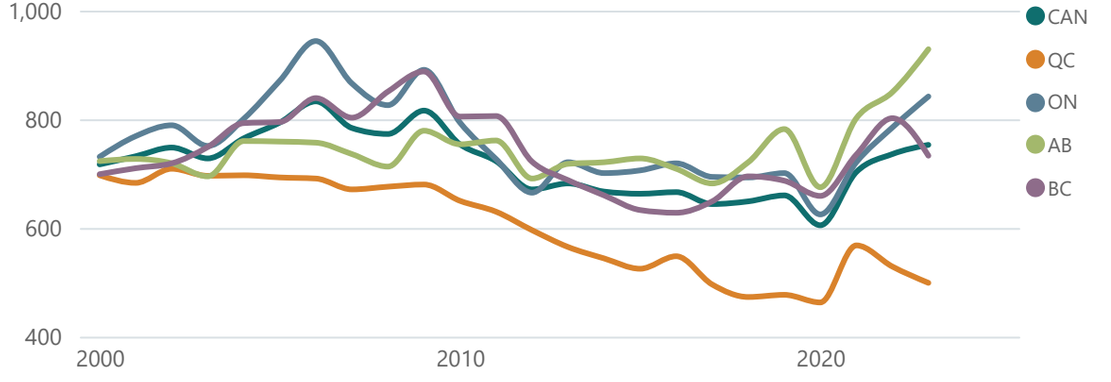
Age-standardized prevalence (%), latest year



British Columbia against Canada, prevalence (%)



New cases per 100,000 (age-standardized), largest provinces and Canada



9.3
British Columbia, latest (%)

9.4
Canada, latest (%)

7
BC's rank of 13 (1 = highest)

Source: Public Health Agency of Canada, Canadian Chronic Disease Surveillance System (CCDSS), Public Health Infobase, read 8 October 2026. Rates are age-standardized; fiscal years (2023 = 2023-24). Open Government Licence - Canada.

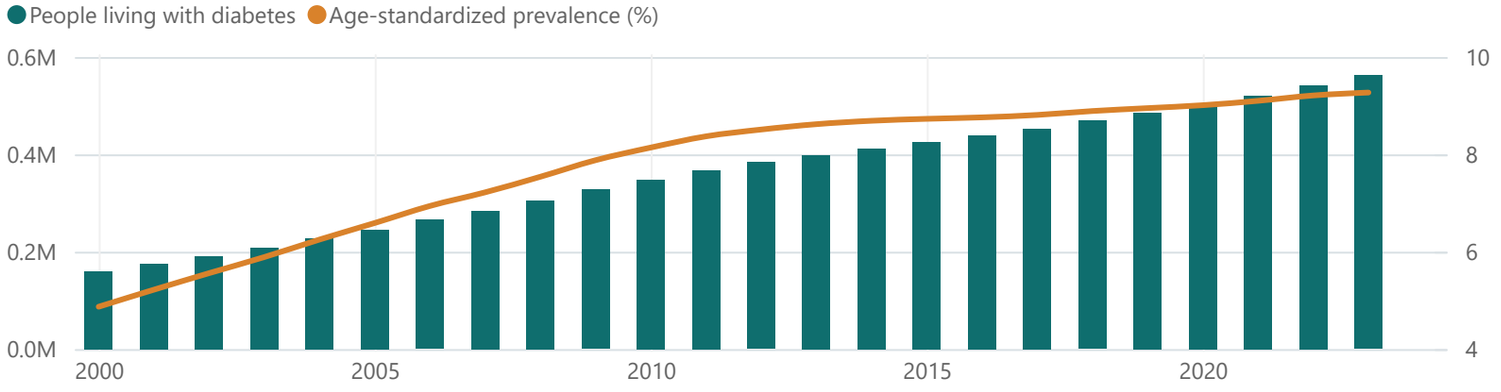
How the numbers are made

Each condition is a case definition run on provincial health administrative data: hospital discharges and physician claims, linked to the insurance registry.

Case definitions (PHAC, 2024)

Condition	Case definition	Ages	Prevalence counted
Diabetes	One or more hospital separation records, or two or more physician claims within two years	1+	For life
Hypertension	One or more hospital separation records, or two or more physician claims within two years	20+	For life
COPD	One or more hospital separation records or one or more physician claims	35+	For life
Asthma	One or more hospital separation records, or two or more physician claims within two years	1+	For life
Dementia	One or more hospital separation records; or three or more physician claims within two years, with at least 30 days between each claim; or one drug prescription or more	65+	For life

Count and rate tell different stories: diabetes in British Columbia



Reading the brief

Prevalence is the share of the population who meet the case definition, counted for life for most conditions.

Age-standardized rates use one standard population, so an older province does not look sicker only because it is older. Use them to compare places and years.

People living with it is a count, not a rate. It grows with ageing and population even when the rate is flat, and it is the number that sizes clinics and budgets.

What it cannot tell you

Administrative data see people who used care. Someone with undiagnosed diabetes, or treated only outside the insured system, is not counted. Definitions are validated per condition by PHAC. Blank years are years the province did not report; they are left blank, never filled.

Source: Public Health Agency of Canada, Canadian Chronic Disease Surveillance System (CCDSS), Public Health Infobase, read 8 October 2026. Rates are age-standardized; fiscal years (2023 = 2023-24). Open Government Licence - Canada.